

The Proposal and the Adjustment

CultureHub LA · residency 16–25 September 2026

What was submitted in May and what is prepared in August are two different programs — this brief puts them side by side



The program as currently drawn: three new MacBook Neos across the front, six salvaged laptops ringed behind. Jeffrey Alan Scudder / Aesthetic Computer.

Submitted	<i>Notepat Jam</i> · 21 May 2026 · one work, six salvaged laptops
Accepted	30 July 2026 · dates 16–25 September · \$2,000 stipend
Prepared now	AC PRESENTS 2 NEW PIECES · <i>Note(s)pat(ial)</i> & <i>The MacNeoPolitan Trio</i> · 11 August 2026
Due today	Artist-page form · seven fields · 11 August 2026

Prepared 11 August 2026. Internal only — this document is not part of any CultureHub submission.

What was submitted

Notepat Jam · 21 May 2026 · the version they accepted

One work on six rescued laptops — one laptop per surround channel — and an ecological claim made structurally rather than rhetorically

The work and the two public events

A six-channel piece performed solo on six aging laptops — donated, thrifted, e-waste-bound — each revived into AC Native, each running notepat and voicing one discrete channel of the 5:1 Kalio surround. Roughly thirty minutes, the audience seated inside the field. Before it, open programming: anyone brings a laptop and boots it into AC Native, and a dead machine becomes an instrument in an hour. Then the concert, livestreamed.

How it answered the call

Old + new tech	AC Native boots a modern creative-computing OS on old, discarded laptops.
Ecological responsibility	“The six instruments are revived e-waste. No new equipment is fabricated for the show — the sustainability is structural, not a statement.”
Localized networks	Six laptops synced over the studio’s own local network — “no internet, no cloud.”
Human connection	Audience inside the field; the open session hands the method back to the room.

What was also promised

The multitrack and the AC Native image released open-source, so the method travels past the residency.

What is prepared now

AC PRESENTS 2 NEW PIECES · titles set 11 August 2026

Two works and nine laptops — half the program is hardware bought new and a second instrument enters that the application never named

The two works

AC OS Special Sign. The six salvaged laptops remain on AC Native, but the piece is now the expanded live version of *Special Sign* — a spatial composition for twelve moving sound bodies, grown from a fixed 1:41 recording. The field rotates, changes speed, and hands voices between machines.

The MacNeoPolitan Trio. New. Three MacBook Neos — indigo, citrus, blush — each played through Menu Band, the menu-bar piano. It runs Menu Band, a shipping universal macOS app: AC Native is x86_64 UEFI only and cannot boot on Apple Silicon, and no copy should ever claim otherwise.

The offering and the billing

Roughly forty minutes across the two works with a guest slot between them, then a conversation. The participation session is now the **Menu Band Jam** — bring a Mac, install Menu Band — with the AC Native USB boot offered as an alternative. Billed **AC PRESENTS 2 NEW PIECES**, replacing the *Whistlegraph presents* line of 9 August.

Sources: CultureHub-LA-2026-Submitted-Application.pdf for the left half; ARTIST-PAGE.md, EVENT-PAGE.md and README.md for the right. PROPOSAL.md and DRAFT.md are an earlier, never-submitted pitch — *The Score Is the Software / REPL* — and are not the record. Billing and titles set by Jeffrey on 11 August.

The five changes

what CultureHub graded · what they would now receive

Four of these are presentational — the ecological answer is the one that reverses a claim the jury read

	Submitted 21 May	Prepared 9 August
Work	<i>Notepat Jam</i> , one work, ~30 minutes	A set list — two works plus a guest slot; neither work is called <i>Notepat Jam</i>
Hardware	Six salvaged laptops. “No new equipment is fabricated for the show.”	Nine laptops: six salvaged, three MacBook Neos bought new
Instrument	notepat, on AC Native, on all six machines	notepat/AC Native for one work; Menu Band on macOS for the other
Workshop	Bring <i>any</i> laptop, boot AC Native, leave with an instrument	Menu Band Jam — requires a Mac; AC Native boot demoted to an alternative
Network	Six machines on the studio LAN, “no internet, no cloud”	NTP clock sync, and guest Wi-Fi requested for the workshop

Two submitted promises are currently unaddressed

- The livestream, which the application stated flatly, is now written as “requested; platform and archive status TBD.”
- The open-source release of the multitrack and the AC Native image appears nowhere in the acceptance packet.

The ecological answer needs a decision rather than a repair

The submitted text made ecology structural: nothing new is built for this show. Half the new program is bought-new hardware. `ARTIST-PAGE.md` already answers this deliberately — the two works are “the same instrument on opposite ends of a computer’s life” — which is a strong reading. It is still a revision of an answer that was graded, and it is better said than discovered.

The public page still shows the old program

`system/public/culture-hub-2026/` reads *Notepat Jam* · *submitted* and now contradicts the program. The embargo forbids publishing the new one before CultureHub’s late-August announcement, so this needs a plan, not a push.

What is actually due today

artist-page form · 11 August 2026

A seven-field Google Form with no project image requested — so the decision lands entirely inside a 50–100 word quotation

Name	Jeffrey Alan Scudder
Bio	Third person, 50–100 words. Current draft: 90 words.
Artist statement	First person, 50–100 words, printed as a quotation credited to the artist. Current draft: 143 words — over cap.
Links	Website and social media
Headshot	Presented 3:2. Chosen file is 1800×1200 — no crop needed.
Photo credit	Courtesy of Jeffrey Alan Scudder
Alt text	Written and ready

Headshot: ...-headshot-3x2-green-laptop.jpg, chosen over the plain blue-background portrait because it shows him playing a computer rather than posing beside one. Courtesy of Jeffrey Alan Scudder.

The statement

the one field where the change is visible · pick one

Both fit the cap — the question is only whether the second work is named in CultureHub's announcement

A — recommended · both works with soft edges

At CultureHub I'm presenting two works for laptop ensemble. *AC OS Special Sign* spreads a spatial composition across six salvaged laptops, each booted into AC Native, the operating system I make; from a live control surface I turn the whole sound field through the room. *The MacNeoPolitan Trio* is newer and still taking shape — three MacBook Neos, each played through Menu Band, my menu-bar piano. One work runs on machines pulled back from e-waste, the other on machines bought new.

81 words. Names both works under the new titles. "Still taking shape" does real work: it earns the right to change the second half without contradicting a published quotation, which matters because the blush Neo is not bought yet. Sets up the salvaged-versus-new reading rather than leaving it to be noticed.

B — fallback · the accepted spine only

At CultureHub I'm turning six salvaged laptops into one instrument. Each boots into AC Native, the operating system I make, and takes a single channel of the studio's surround system, so the audience sits inside the sound rather than facing it. From a live control surface I rotate the whole field through the room, change its speed, and move voices between machines. The instruments are rescued, not bought — I want a computer to hold an instrument the way it holds a clock.

83 words. Holds the spine they accepted and keeps the ecological answer intact. Names no work title at all, so the second half can arrive later. Kept here only as a retreat: it hides a decision already made, and the set list would then contradict the artist page.

At this length neither statement can explain the change. That belongs in a short separate note to Mattie, or nowhere.

Open items

ranked by how soon they bite

One of these has been sitting for six days and was mistakenly logged as waiting on CultureHub

The corrected LOA is unsigned

ACTION — SIX DAYS OPEN

CultureHub sent a corrected LOA on **5 August**, and the August 3 reply had offered to re-sign immediately. It has not been signed or returned, and README.md still lists this as awaiting *them*. Clear it alongside the form.

Who is the guest on the bill?

ACTION — NEEDED BEFORE ANY PUBLIC LISTING

The set list holds a third slot for one invited performer, and nobody has been named or asked. A guest changes the running time, the rider, whether a fee is owed out of the \$2,000 stipend, and the credit line CultureHub publishes — so it stays *to be confirmed*, and nothing public should imply a guest until someone accepts.

The third MacBook Neo is not purchased

HEDGED, NOT BLOCKING

Blush, indigo and citrus are Apple's own colour names. Do not describe the blush finish more specifically until the machine is in hand. Statement A calls the trio "still taking shape," which is what makes naming it now safe.

Two files to know about, neither due today

Program image	macneopolitan/gens/program.png (1536×1024) is gone. Only the 900×600 brief/media/mn-program.jpg survives — the image on this cover and the broadside. Regenerate from program.illy.txt before any poster send.
artist-page-packet.pdf	Stale: single-work statement, bio without Menu Band, blue-background headshot, old project image. Today is a form, so nothing needs regenerating — but do not attach this file to anything.

Still awaiting CultureHub: confirmation of the proposed public-programme dates and times, the technical contact, and the equipment inventory. The working technical deadline is **16 August**, one month out.



Internal decision brief · prepared 11 August 2026 · sources: submitted application PDF, the August 3 and August 5 residency emails, and the acceptance packet.